

3. **Quick Deployment:** Cloud services can manage the large amount of infrastructural workload which allows faster deployment of solutions, especially for smaller companies. A PaaS allows a developer to focus on building code without any hardware/software hassle, and this allows him to test and simulate his code and hence deploy quicker.
4. **More computing power:** Computing is done on the cloud hence large scale computations can be managed by better machines.
5. **Increased Collaboration:** Because of easier access, employees can share information and work on documents and shared applications simultaneously. Web- apps such as Google Apps and Zimbra are examples of services that allow this sort of collaborative utility.
6. **Less expense on hardware and software:** As Cloud-based services utilise hardware and software on the cloud there is no need for the user to invest in high end software or hardware, or be tied to the constant upgrade cycles, as usually only system capable of running a web browser is required at the user end.
7. **Automatic and secure data backup:** Estimates suggest that about 800,000 laptops are lost every year at airports alone! Data backup ensures that you don't lose more than just your laptop, though external hard-disks and the like are geographically challenged ways of backing up. Backing up data on the cloud is secure and almost immune to any sort of disaster. Just back up, and restoring is as easy as logging in from a new device and waiting for it all to download again. For companies, this is especially important, and cloud-based services ensure maximum durability and safety of data.

Disadvantages of cloud-based services

1. **You need to be connected:** This is one of the major drawbacks of every cloud service. You are at the mercy of the internet, so much so that when the net is down you just cannot work. Varying bandwidth at any end might cause errors to creep in and this limits the use of cloud services for less tolerant needs such as HPC. Some services are trying to incorporate offline modes as an alternative for bandwidth sensitive nations such as India, but by far reliable connectivity is the only real option.
2. **Latency:** Latency is the time taken for the user system to interact with machines in the cloud. This is an obvious issue with cloud based services. Cloud based apps will have higher latency than native apps installed on a user's system since there will be an added time of user end communi-